SMF Member Case Studies — Grant and Programme Journeys

■■ ILLUSTRATIVE / SYNTHETIC — for PoC testing only, not real SMF members.

Every company name, person, dollar figure, date and outcome in this file is FICTIONAL. These five case studies were written to exercise retrieval and multi-document reasoning in the Dify RAG proof-of-concept. They are plausible composites, not records of actual SMF members or actual grant awards.

The scheme mechanics referenced (support percentages, caps, eligibility tests, application channels) are drawn from the real scheme notes in this corpus and were correct as at 26 July 2026. The *company circumstances and outcomes* are invented. Do not cite these cases to a member, a journalist, or in any SMF publication. Do not treat any outcome here as an indication of approval likelihood.

Case Study 1 — Precision Engineering: "Tanjong Precision Works Pte Ltd"

Profile (fictional): Tuas-based precision machining shop. 62 employees, S$14 million annual turnover, 100% Singapore-owned. Supplies machined housings to semiconductor equipment OEMs.

Problem: Job scheduling ran on spreadsheets. Quoting took three days, and the company was losing tenders on lead time. Two of five CNC machining centres sat idle on night shift because there was no reliable way to plan unattended runs.

Route taken:

1. **PSG** for a pre-approved manufacturing execution / job-scheduling system from the GoBusiness catalogue. Passed the SME test easily (turnover well under S$100 million, headcount under 200) and the 30% local equity test.
2. **EDG (Innovation & Productivity — Automation)** eighteen months later for a bespoke project: integrating the MES with machine-tool controllers and a pallet-changer to enable lights-out night-shift running. This was correctly routed to EDG rather than PSG because the integration work was custom and the equipment was not on the PSG catalogue.
3. **SFEC** applied on top of the PSG project to offset part of the remaining out-of-pocket cost, within the S$7,000 enterprise-transformation sub-cap.

What went wrong first: the finance manager placed a 10% deposit with the MES vendor to lock in a quarter-end discount, three weeks before submitting the PSG application. The application was rejected. The company had to renegotiate with the vendor, have the deposit refunded, and re-apply — losing four months.

Illustrative outcome: quoting turnaround reduced from three days to same-day; night-shift spindle utilisation materially improved. *(Figures deliberately omitted — any specific number here would be invented.)*

Advisory lesson: the no-payment-before-application rule is absolute. Brief the member's finance function, not just the operations lead.

Case Study 2 — Food Manufacturing: "Kim Heng Foods Pte Ltd"

Profile (fictional): Family-run sauce and condiment manufacturer, Woodlands. 38 employees, S$9 million turnover, second-generation management. Holds an SFA licence and is classified under SSIC 10.

Problem: Two ageing ammonia chillers and an inefficient steam boiler were driving a utilities bill that had become the third-largest cost line. Separately, the company wanted to start exporting to Vietnam.

Route taken:

1. **Energy Efficiency Grant (EEG), Base tier** — Food Manufacturing sits within SSIC 10–32, so the company qualified as a Manufacturing applicant, with 30% local shareholding and group turnover far below the S$500 million ceiling. Because the chillers and the boiler were different equipment types, **two separate applications** were required.
2. **EEG Advanced tier** was considered for a larger refrigeration overhaul, since Manufacturing is one of only two sectors eligible for Advanced tier. The company was advised that the S$350,000 Advanced tier cap is **combined across base and advanced tiers**, not additive.
3. **MRA** for Vietnam market entry — the company had never sold into Vietnam, so it comfortably passed the "sales must not have exceeded S$100,000 in any of the preceding three years" test. It applied under the Overseas Business Development pillar for distributor identification.

What went wrong first: the company initially planned to apply for MRA to attend a food trade fair in Ho Chi Minh City that turned out to be a **LEAD-supported** event, which MRA does not fund. The application had to be re-scoped to a distributor-identification project instead.

Advisory lesson: always cross-check the LEAD event list before recommending MRA for a trade fair. And remind food manufacturers that they are "Manufacturing" for EEG purposes, not "Food Services" — the two have different SSIC tests and the Food Services stream requires an SFA licence under SSIC 56 or 68104.

Case Study 3 — Metal Stamping: "Guan Seng Metal Stamping Pte Ltd"

Profile (fictional): Progressive-die metal stamping house in Kranji. 91 employees, S$22 million turnover. Ageing workforce; average operator age in the high forties.

Problem: Could not hire press setters. Three experienced setters were within five years of retirement and the skill was not being transferred.

Route taken:

1. **Career Conversion Programme (Place-and-Train)** to bring in four mid-career hires from unrelated industries and reskill them as press setters through on-the-job training. All four were Singapore Citizens over 21 who had been out of their previous field for more than two years, and the new role was substantially different from their prior work — satisfying the "conversion" test.
2. **CCP (Job Redesign Reskilling)** for two existing quality inspectors moved into a redesigned in-line vision-inspection role.
3. **SFEC** stacked on top of the CCP — WSG explicitly lists CCPs as SFEC-supportable programmes.
4. **EDG (Automation)** the following year to install the vision-inspection cell the redesigned roles were built around.

What went wrong first: the company's first CCP candidate was the operations director's nephew. WSG's rules exclude individuals related to shareholders of the hiring company, and the candidate was withdrawn.

Second issue: HR offered the four new hires nine-month probationary contracts. CCP requires an employment contract on permanent terms **or on contract terms of no less than one year**. The contracts had to be reissued.

Advisory lesson: CCP's two hard structural rules — the minimum 12-month contract and the relationship exclusions — catch out family-run manufacturers repeatedly. Note also that the headline **90% salary support is the enhanced rate** for long-term unemployed or mature (40+) jobseekers, not the universal rate.

Case Study 4 — Electronics Assembly: "Novara Electronics Assembly Pte Ltd"

Profile (fictional): Contract electronics manufacturer, Ang Mo Kio. 145 employees, S$48 million turnover. Runs four SMT lines. Has an in-house IT team of three, including one software engineer and one data analyst.

Problem: Wanted to build a custom AI model to predict solder-joint defects from AOI image data and process parameters — something no off-the-shelf product on the PSG catalogue could do.

Route taken:

1. **PSG** was assessed first and ruled out for the AI model itself: the requirement was bespoke, not a catalogue solution. PSG was still used separately for a pre-approved cybersecurity solution.
2. **Enterprise Compute Initiative (ECI)** — administered by DISG, not IMDA or EnterpriseSG. The company met the harder bars: more than 10 Singapore headcount, at least two in-house technical staff, and a prior proof-of-concept AI build. Applied via FormSG with Corppass and audited financials, and was notified within four weeks. Consulting cost support is 70% of actual costs, capped at S$105,000 per company, against a supportable consulting cost ceiling of S$150,000; the company funded the remaining 30%.
3. **A*STAR T-Up **was explored in parallel for a two-year secondment of a machine-vision researcher, at up to 70% of allowable costs for an SME, capped at S$250,000 per project. The company qualified: Singapore-incorporated, over 30% local equity, and under the 200-employee threshold despite being over S$48 million in revenue (T-Up's test is turnover ≤ S$100 million** OR** headcount ≤ 200).

What went wrong first: the company assumed the AWS and Microsoft credit ceilings quoted under ECI were government cash grants. They are **cloud service provider credits and services**, not cash. The government's cash support under ECI is the consulting co-funding only.

Advisory lesson: ECI is for digitally mature firms. Screen for the ≥10 headcount, ≥2 in-house technical staff and prior-AI-build requirements before recommending it — most SMF members will fail these and should be routed to PSG-funded GenAI solutions instead.

Case Study 5 — Packaging: "Everbright Packaging Industries Pte Ltd"

Profile (fictional): Corrugated and flexible packaging converter, Sungei Kadut. 74 employees, S$31 million turnover. Customers increasingly asking for recycled-content and carbon-footprint data.

Problem: Needed to (a) fund a new die-cutting line, (b) build a sustainability strategy to answer customer ESG questionnaires, and (c) manage cashflow across the transition.

Route taken:

1. **EDG (Core Capabilities — Business Strategy Development, sustainability strand)** for a sustainability strategy project covering assessment of sustainability risks and opportunities, strategy development, a governance framework, and metrics and targets. The company was advised that sustainability-related EDG projects have been supported at **up to 70%** rather than the standard 50% for SMEs, but that the end date of that enhanced rate is not published and had to be confirmed with EnterpriseSG.
2. **EFS – SME Fixed Assets Loan** through a participating bank to finance the die-cutting line, over a repayment period of up to 15 years. The company was carefully told that EnterpriseSG's 50% risk-share applies **between EnterpriseSG and the bank on insolvency** — the company repays 100% of the loan.
3. **EFS – SME Working Capital Loan** (maximum S$500,000 per borrower, up to 5 years) to bridge cashflow during installation.
4. **EEG Base tier** for a more efficient compressed-air system serving the new line.

What went wrong first: the managing director told the board that the government would "cover half the loan". This is the single most common EFS misunderstanding and it created a real budgeting error that had to be corrected before the board approved the capex.

Second issue: the company tried to claim ISO 9001 recertification costs under EDG Standards Adoption. Basic standards — including ISO 9001, SS 506, SS 444 and ISO 45001 — are explicitly excluded, as are annual surveillance and recertification costs for standards the company already holds.

Advisory lesson: be explicit and repetitive that EFS is risk-sharing, not a subsidy. And check the standards exclusion list before any Standards Adoption conversation.

Cross-Cutting Patterns Across These (Fictional) Cases

1. **Premature payment or contract signing** is the most common cause of rejection across PSG, EDG, MRA and EEG.
2. **PSG vs EDG routing** turns on whether the solution is on the pre-approved catalogue (PSG) or bespoke and individually assessed (EDG). The same cost cannot be claimed under both.
3. **Stacking is normal:** SFEC sits on top of PSG, EDG, MRA and CCP; EFS finances what a grant only part-funds; EEG covers energy equipment that EDG explicitly excludes.
4. **SME size tests differ by scheme.** PSG, MRA and T-Up use ≤S$100 million turnover **or** ≤200 employees. EEG and base EFS eligibility use ≤S$500 million group turnover. EFS's *SME* facilities revert to the S$100 million / 200 employee test.
5. **The 30% local equity test** applies to PSG, EDG, MRA, EEG, EFS and T-Up alike (with a documented waiver for data centre users under EEG).
6. **2026 is a transition year.** EDGE consolidates EDG, PSG and MRA from 2H 2026, and SFEC's final claims are due in 2H 2026. Every one of these fictional members would need re-advising in the second half of the year.

File status: SYNTHETIC. Created 26 July 2026 for the Dify RAG proof-of-concept. Scheme mechanics cross-referenced against the real scheme notes in this corpus. Company identities, figures and outcomes invented.